PsychArmor Midpoint Memo

To	PsychArmor project partners and MLD-371 instructional team
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Date	October 16, 2026
Subject	AI support for resume review and first-round screening

Overview

We propose an AI screening assistant for steps 5 and 6 of PsychArmor's hiring process: resume review and the first-round screening call to address hiring efficiencies. To do so, we built and published a working prototype. An applicant uploads a resume and records spoken answers to five standard questions. The tool transcribes the answers, organizes job-related evidence against a staff-approved checklist, shows the source passage behind every item, and marks what it cannot find. PsychArmor staff verify each source and decide who advances. Later interviews, work samples, and final decisions stay with people. PsychArmor provides military culture education through courses, customized training, and consulting. [1] The process map, friction table, scope detail, next steps, and interview questions appear in Appendices A through E. Note: a link to the prototype can be found here.

The process map and how it compares to PsychArmor's account

Appendix A maps an assumed 11-step hiring process running 14 to 21 weeks, with a one to two week wait after resume review and again after the first-round call. Six steps carry high friction. Two of them, steps 5 and 6, sit inside the pilot.

PsychArmor has not given us a complete process map, so the map is our inference. Every step, duration, wait, and friction rating in Appendix A is our assumption, drawn from psycharmor.org/careers and /team, and from general nonprofit hiring practices. [2] We are still waiting for staff member confirmation on the number of steps, who reviews resumes, how many applications a posting draws, or how long review actually takes. We treat the map as a set of hypotheses rather than a baseline. If PsychArmor runs a shorter process, or if resume review is already quick. Validating the map with the hiring owner is the first item in the scope below, and it gates the build.

How we categorized the frictions

We sorted each step by the kind of work its friction represents. Friction that is the cost of judgment stays with people. Friction that is administrative repetition is a candidate for help. Appendix B gives the hypothesis behind each rating.

Worth optimizing. At step 5, every reviewer searches every resume for the same evidence. At step 6, staff schedule calls, ask the same standard questions, and leave notes scattered across documents. Automated evidence retrieval and a recorded interview should remove most of that cost without touching assessment. Step 2 is worth optimizing lightly, since observable criteria written once can feed the screening checklist. Step 9, reference checks, carries scheduling friction worth addressing later, outside this pilot.

Worth keeping. Headcount approval (1), the panel interview (7), the short list (8), and the offer (10) all carry real friction, but it is the cost of deciding about resources, ability, and the job itself. Posting (3) and

applying (4) cost staff little, and adding steps there would only raise applicant burden. Background checks and onboarding (11) are external waits PsychArmor cannot shorten.

The prototype: https://psycharmor-evidence-pilot.mwosje1.chatgpt.site/

What we built. A published web tool with two sides. On the applicant side, a resume upload and five separate recorders, one per question, each with its own progress status, transcript, and written alternative for anyone who cannot or prefers not to record. The questions cover program coordination, adapting training to an audience, transition challenges facing service members and families, competing stakeholder deadlines, and online learning tools (Appendix E). Recording is microphone only; the video option was removed. Applicants can stop, listen back, re-record, delete, and download their audio. On the reviewer side, evidence organized against an editable checklist, source-linked quotations, reviewer corrections, manual review, and a downloadable review report. Because the actual role and approved requirements are unknown, we used an illustrative role and labeled the checklist as needing PsychArmor approval.

What worked. Transcription and evidence analysis run against a connected AI service and performed correctly on fictional audio. Source-linked quotation held up. Every evidence item traces to a passage a reviewer can open and check. The written alternative works end to end, so the tool never forces anyone to record.

What did not work. Three things. Transcription failed on first test because the service account had no credit. It then failed again on the published site: the credential existed in our local build but had not been carried into the hosted environment, so a tool that worked on a laptop was inert on the web. Third, the interface blocked its own users. A connection check could leave the Transcribe button disabled with no explanation, and the processing-permission checkbox sat below all five questions, so applicants met the blocker before they saw the control that cleared it. We added button guidance, a connection retry, and errors placed beside the relevant question, then replaced the checkbox with a plain notice at the point of action. The workflow is now Record, Stop, Transcribe, with a line stating that Transcribe sends the recording to the AI service. Recording alone sends nothing.

We also published the build with link-based access. The intended model is that PsychArmor issues access to a named applicant and the materials stay secure, which link-based access does not deliver. Only fictional applicants have been used, so nothing was exposed, but the gap between the design and the build is real. Closing it is now a named component of the scope below.

What surprised us. The AI was not the hard part. Everything that failed was ordinary deployment work: billing, secret management across two environments, and button states. The second surprise was how much the consent control shaped behavior. A checkbox in the wrong place stopped people from using the tool, while a one-line notice at the moment of action did not. Physical microphone capture across different devices and browsers remains untested and is the largest open risk on the applicant side.

Scope of the final deliverable

The deliverable still covers steps 5 and 6 only, and now has six components (Appendix C). Role setup produces one approved question set and checklist, with required and preferred items and guidance on equivalent experience. Applicant intake provides resume and audio upload, the written route, applicant notice, and correction support. The reviewer workspace shows source-linked evidence, uncertainty flags, editable notes, and a human decision record. Access control replaces link-based access with issued,

applicant-specific access and a defined retention schedule, and must be in place before any real application. The AI governance policy is adopted before the tool touches live applicant data. Evaluation and handoff delivers a manual baseline, test cases, time and error findings, a user guide, and a manual fallback.

Out of scope: sourcing, panel interviews, work samples, reference and background checks, offers, and onboarding. Integration with existing hiring software depends on PsychArmor confirming its tools and access requirements.

Validation plan. The pilot gate is a 25 percent cut in median total review effort. At midpoint we claim no reduction. The test uses 12 to 20 synthetic applications containing clear, incomplete, conflicting, and hard-to-transcribe answers. Two reviewers independently identify evidence and reconcile differences, then AI-assisted review is compared against the same checklist done manually. We count verification and correction time, and measure applicant effort and scheduling time separately. Accuracy gates: every evidence claim traceable, no fabricated quotations, at least 95 percent of checked citations supporting their claims, and at least 90 percent of reviewer-agreed evidence retrieved. Microphone capture across devices and browsers is added as a gate. A small synthetic test cannot establish population-level fairness or real scheduling savings. If a live call proves essential, we keep it and narrow the tool's role.

Next steps run in three stages: the hiring owner validates the map and the role, we build and test intake, evidence review, and access control while PsychArmor adopts the governance policy, then a limited parallel trial with human decisions leads to a recommendation to adopt, revise, or return to the manual process (Appendix D).

AI governance policy

PsychArmor adopts the policy before the tool touches real applicant data, and PsychArmor owns it. We draft it; PsychArmor approves it, maintains it, and answers for outcomes. PsychArmor also approves each role's checklist.

The tool may retrieve and organize job-related evidence and draft follow-up questions. It may not rank, advance, or reject applicants, or score voice, accent, emotion, appearance, personality, or disability, a risk federal guidance flags for voice-based assessments. [4] The recording supplies words only. A person records every decision.

Applicants receive notice before they begin and a second notice at the point of transcription stating that the recording is sent to the AI service. Recording alone sends nothing. An equivalent written route is available for every question and carries no disadvantage. This replaces the consent checkbox used in the first build, which blocked use without improving understanding.

Access is issued to a named applicant rather than open by link. Applicant data stays in approved, restricted accounts under vendor terms that bar model training, and instructions embedded in applications are treated as untrusted content. The system logs checklist and model versions, source evidence, corrections, and decisions. California's automated-decision regulations, effective October 1, 2025, require keeping covered records at least four years; [3] PsychArmor confirms scope and legal holds before setting deletion schedules. PsychArmor tests accuracy and responses to identity cues before launch, pauses use if the tool invents evidence or misses qualifications, and reviews the policy after the pilot and at least annually.

Human review and bias testing do not by themselves establish legal compliance. Employment protections still apply when AI is used. [5]

Sources

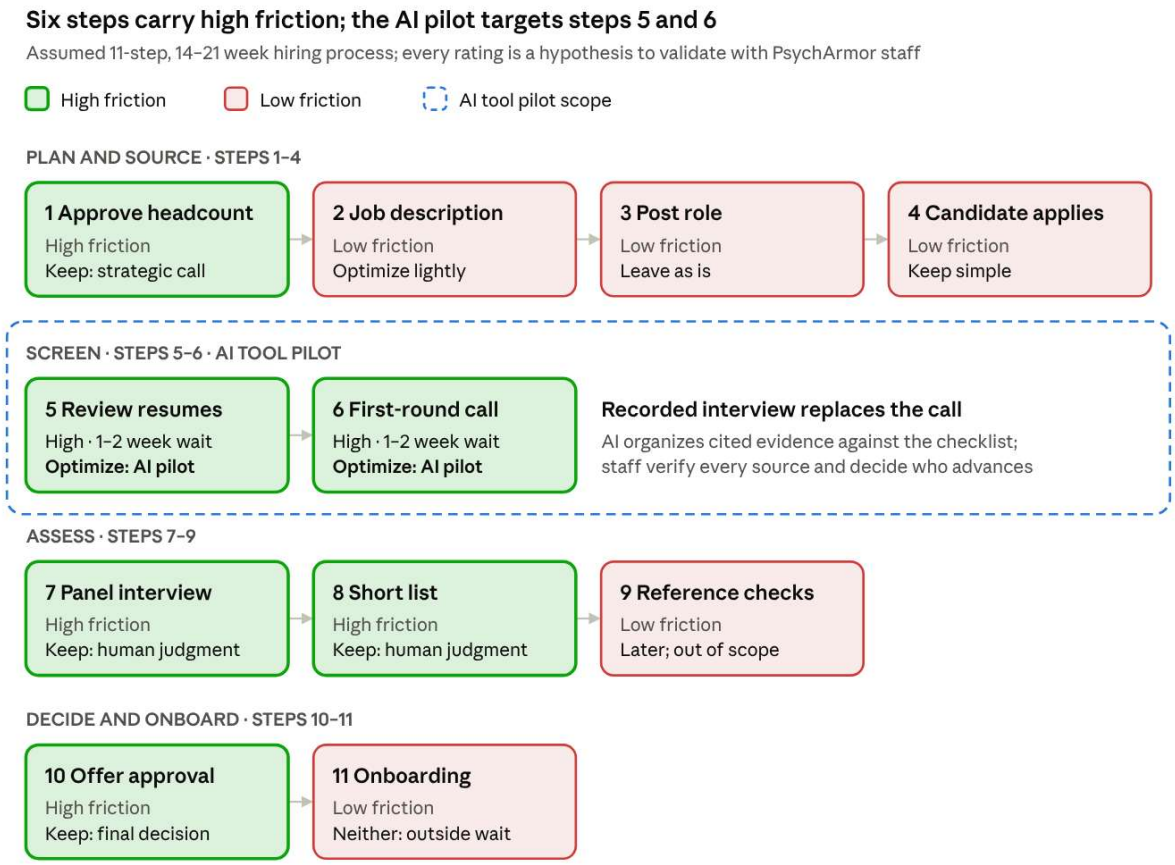
Web sources reviewed October 16, 2026. Pilot design and targets are our recommendations; workflow and timing come from the hypothesis map.

1. PsychArmor. Home page: organizational mission and services. psycharmor.org
2. Kennedy Coders. PsychArmor Hiring Map, draft v2, October 8, 2026. Cites psycharmor.org/careers and /team; process details are assumptions requiring staff validation.
3. California Civil Rights Department. Approval of automated-decision regulations, June 30, 2025; rulemaking record and final text.
4. U.S. Department of Justice. Algorithms, Artificial Intelligence, and Disability Discrimination in Hiring, May 12, 2022.
5. U.S. Equal Employment Opportunity Commission. Assessing Adverse Impact in Software, Algorithms, and Artificial Intelligence Used in Employment Selection Procedures Under Title VII of the Civil Rights Act of 1964, May 18, 2023.

Preparation note: AI assisted research synthesis, drafting, and formatting of this memo.

Appendix A: Hiring Process Map

The assumed 11-step process from the supplied hypothesis map, draft v2, October 8, 2026, rated for friction. [2]



Hiring friction map. 11 steps, 4 phases.

Green marks high friction, red low; the dashed band is the pilot. Every step outside it stays with people, and Appendix B gives each step's hypothesis.

Appendix B: Friction Hypotheses by Step

Every rating is a hypothesis to validate with PsychArmor staff, not a measured baseline.

#	Step	Friction	Where the friction sits	Hypothesis	Keep or optimize
1	Identify need, approve headcount	Low	Waiting on budget sign-off	A strategic call on resources and mission	Keep
2	Write job description	Low	Drafted from scratch; vague mission fit	Observable criteria written once can feed the screening checklist	Optimize
3	Post role	Low	Routine posting	Little to gain	Keep
4	Candidate applies	Low (staff)	Applicant effort	Added steps would raise applicant burden	Keep
5	Review resumes	High	Each reviewer searches every resume for the same evidence; 1 to 2 week handoff	Automated evidence retrieval cuts search time without replacing assessment	Optimize (pilot)
6	First-round screening call	High	Scheduling; the same standard questions asked repeatedly; notes scattered; 1 to 2 week wait	A recorded interview with standard questions removes scheduling and repetition	Optimize (pilot)
7	Panel interview	High	Coordinating panel calendars	The conversation is core judgment; only logistics are costly	Keep judgment
8	Short list	High	Reviewer time	The most direct evidence of job performance	Keep
9	Reference checks	Low	Scheduling calls with referees	Worth optimizing later	Keep
10	Approve and make offer	High	Approval chain	Final decision and negotiation belong to people	Keep
11	Background check, onboarding	Low	Third-party processing; notice periods	A fixed external constraint	Keep

Appendix C: Scope of Final Deliverable

Component	Deliverable	PsychArmor confirms
Role setup	One approved question set and checklist, with required and preferred items and guidance on equivalent experience	Role, requirements, which items belong in screening
Applicant intake	Resume and audio upload, an equivalent written route, applicant notice, correction support	Accessibility needs, notice wording
Reviewer workspace	Source-linked evidence, uncertainty flags, editable notes, a human decision record	Who reviews, existing hiring software
Access control	Issued, applicant-specific access replacing link-based access; defined storage and retention. Required before any real application	Who issues access, retention schedule, legal holds
AI governance policy	A written policy for the tool's use, adopted before any live applicant data	Policy approval, vendor terms
Evaluation and handoff	Manual baseline, test cases, time and error findings, user guide, manual fallback	Application volume, baseline staff effort

Appendix D: Next Steps

Stage	Action and completion condition
Validate	Hiring owner confirms the role, requirements, screening steps, volume, baseline effort, and the friction ratings in Appendix B.
Build and test	Implement intake, evidence review, and access control; test accessible alternatives, identity cues, and microphone capture across devices and browsers; fix material errors; adopt the governance policy.
Pilot and hand off	If approved, run a limited parallel trial with human decisions; recommend adoption, revision, or the manual fallback.

Appendix E: Interview Questions Used in the Prototype

Five standard questions, each with its own recorder, progress status, transcript, and written alternative. The set is illustrative and requires PsychArmor approval before use with real applicants.

Q1. Tell us about a program you coordinated from start to finish.

Q2. Describe a time you adapted to training for a specific audience.

Q3. What challenges do service members and families face during transition, and how might training help?

Q4. How do you handle competing deadlines from more than one stakeholder?

Q5. Which tools have you used to build or manage online learning?